

Siddharth Rao

Senior Product Manager

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Professional Summary

Senior Product Manager with 7 years of experience — 3 years in port and terminal operations at JNPT, followed by 4 years in logistics SaaS product roles. Deep understanding of how freight moves through Indian ports, the operational pressures on freight forwarders and CHAs, and where software consistently fails them. Led product function independently at a startup for 2.5 years.

Work Experience

Head of Product (SPM-equivalent)

Portwise Technologies Pvt. Ltd. (Port & Logistics SaaS, 55 employees), Mumbai · Aug 2022 – Present

- Led the product function as the sole senior PM for 2.5 years — owned roadmap, discovery, and delivery with no PM manager; reported directly to co-founder
- Rebuilt the entire product architecture from a single monolith to a modular suite after understanding that freight forwarders needed to adopt specific features without the full platform commitment — decision made after 3 months of customer discovery, not based on engineering preference
- Shipped 12 features in 3 years; killed 4 post-launch based on usage data; one killed feature was my own idea from the previous roadmap cycle
- Designed the JNPT container tracking integration after understanding the ICEGATE API limitations from my time in terminal operations — feature worked because I knew what the data actually contained, not just the field names
- Grew managed accounts from 8 to 34 over 2 years; sat in on every new customer onboarding in the first year to understand where the product broke

Senior Product Manager

LogiStack Technologies (Freight Management SaaS), Mumbai · Jan 2021 – Jul 2022

- Owned the freight booking and carrier allocation module — led a 4-person squad
- Shipped a multi-carrier rate comparison feature that increased booking conversion from the platform by 22%
- Led the integration with ICEGATE for automated customs filing status — reduced the most common client support ticket by 60%

Terminal Operations Executive → Senior Operations Executive

JNPT (Jawaharlal Nehru Port Trust), Nhava Sheva · Jun 2017 – Dec 2020

- Managed berth allocation, vessel scheduling, and container handling coordination at JNPT's Terminal 4
- Coordinated daily with shipping lines, freight forwarders, CHAs, and customs authorities on vessel and cargo clearance timelines
- Led the night shift terminal operations team of 18 for 14 months — managed emergency cargo releases, vessel delays, and chassis shortages without escalation in most cases
- Built the shift's first digital container dwell-time tracker; port management adopted it across 2 other shifts within 3 months

Education

MBA, Operations · Jamnalal Bajaj Institute of Management Studies, Mumbai · 2015–2017

B.E., Mechanical Engineering · VJTI Mumbai · 2011–2015 · First Division

Skills & Certifications

Product strategy & roadmap · Port & terminal operations · Freight forwarding domain · ICEGATE · CargoWise · JIRA · Figma · SQL · Miro

FIATA Advanced Freight Forwarding Module (2019) · SAFe 5 Product Owner/PM (2022)